

Intro to Algorithms Notes

Based on Cormen et al.

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1 Chapter 1: The Role of Algorithms in Computing

1.1 What is an Algorithm?

Definition 1.1. An ***algorithm*** is a well-defined computational procedure that takes some value or set of values as ***input*** and produces some value or set of values as ***output***.

1.2 Algorithms as a Technology

Different solutions to the same problem have different efficiencies in space used and time spent solving the problem. We will learn more about these when we discuss sorting algorithms and how they all differ in terms of space and time complexity.